

S05-04 - The Soul-Audit Wraiths

Player text

The drifting things reach you, and they do not swing for your body. One presses a cold hand to a face and reaches inside, dredging up something buried. The other simply passes through a body like a door, and for a horrible moment a soul stands outside itself, unable to move, unable to act, while the fight roars on without them. These are worse than the dead. These ask questions you do not want to answer.

Public objective

Survive the wraiths, protect each other, and keep the ritual on track.

Raw source

- Id: S05-04
- Type: scene
- Sectionid: ACT-FIVE
- Sectiontitle: Act Five: The Ward Renewal
- Title: The Soul-Audit Wraiths
- Shorttitle: Memory Delve
- Order: 604
- Playersafe: True
- Completioneligible: True
- Image: assets/scenes/S05-04-legacy-security-skeletons.png
- Alt: Legacy Security Skeletons scene art for The Ward Renewal.
- Caption: The wraiths make care and grounding as important as attacks.
- Mood: The Ward Renewal
- Gmgoal: Escalate into wraith pressure where memory, vulnerability, and rescue become the emotional core.
- Publicobjective: Survive the wraiths, protect each other, and keep the ritual on track.
- Readaloud: The drifting things reach you, and they do not swing for your body. One presses a cold hand to a face and reaches inside, dredging up something buried. The other simply passes through a body like a door, and for a horrible moment a soul stands outside itself, unable to move, unable to act, while the fight roars on without them. These are worse than the dead. These ask questions you do not want to answer.
- Gmnotes: Use Pass-Through sparingly. Rescue and grounding should return players to action quickly.
- Gmscript: Say: "These do not want your blood. They want your worst memory and your soul out of your body. If someone gets knocked loose, protecting and calling them back is the scene."
- Gmreadaloud: The drifting things reach you. They do not swing for your body. A cold hand reaches inside memory. A soul can stand outside itself for one horrible moment.
- Gmchecklist: Use Soul-Audit Wraith stats: Difficulty 13, HP 6, Stress 3, ATK +3, Lifedrain Far 2d6+8 magic. Physical resistance halves incoming physical damage,

round up. Memory Delve: Close attack; ask for a terrifying childhood moment, then 3d4+9 magic and Vulnerable until next rest. Pass-Through: spend Fear, Melee attack; on hit target is Untethered until countdown ticks down. Whole party Untethered at once: all mark 2 HP, souls return, condition clears. Track protected_whom as the primary emotional write.

- Gmprivate: Memory Delve hooks live in perCharacterLayer. Use the active PC's hook if helpful, but accept any player-safe version. Soul-economy stays a seed. The word itself is GM-only.
- Playertakeaway: You cannot out-muscle these; protect each other, cover the Untethered, and endure.
- Storytakeaway: The wraiths attack who you are, not just what you can take.
- Mechanictakeaway: Memory Delve, Vulnerable, Pass-Through, Untethered, and grounding an ally make care a live combat mechanic.
- Rollcards: s05-04-shatter-the-skeleton-formation S05-04 Shatter the skeleton formation Shatter the skeleton formation Strength Knowledge Strength Knowledge 13 Strength breaks bodies; Knowledge breaks the pattern animating them. Old labor-debt bodies keep rising in formation. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that follows from the fiction. Old labor-debt bodies keep rising in formation. Use a hard complication, lost time, worse position, GM Fear, or mark Stress. Apply an official condition only if the fiction and rules justify it. The attempt falls short, but a partial thread appears. Offer one clue, weak position, or safer follow-up. The PC gets the core result, but it...
- Entityids: legacy-security-skeleton market-correction open-valetm-ritual-site whitefire-custodian ritual-countdown garrick-reed damage-armor
- Entities: legacy-security-skeleton Legacy Security Skeleton enemy Enemy / Combatant assets/icons/enemy.png assets/npc-images/legacy-security-skeleton/portrait_base.png LEG-uh-see seh-KYUR-ih-tee SKEL-eh-tun Obsolete security protocols made bone and rust. Soul-debt canon combatant. Legacy Security Skeleton a rusted dead guard still obeying a security routine nobody living remembers Not malice, momentum. A duty that outlived the man and a debt that kept the bones. Somewhere under the patrol loop is someone who wants, very quietly, for the post to finally fall. Hold the post because the old order is the only command still left. Permit... expired. a rusted dead guard still obeying a security routine nobody living remembers npc-profile-v1 NPC_System_Packet + image-informed hardening True Legacy Security Skeleton a rusted dead guard still obeying a security routine nobody living remembers A rusted skeleton guard in chain scraps and bead charms stands with a cracked skull, old badge fragments, and road-dust still clinging to the bones. Legacy Security Skeleton: a rusted dead guard still obeying a security routine nobody living remembers Legacy Security Skeleton LEG-uh-see seh-KYUR-ih-tee...
- Locationids: open-valetm-ritual-site
- Clueids: market-correction legacy-security-badge
- Statecontrols: ward_stability Ward Stability select fragile stable ritual_prep

Ritual Prep select unready ready ritual_countdown Ritual Countdown number 10 8
 ritual_outcome Ritual Outcome select unresolved clean costly pyrrhic protected_whom
 Protected Whom select unresolved custodian party hush shared custodian_fate
 Custodian Fate select unresolved well drained dying strixwolf_disposition Strixwolf
 Disposition select unresolved calm hostile killed strixwolf_outcome Strixwolf
 Outcome select unresolved calmed helped avoided attacked killed strixwolf_trust
 Strixwolf Trust number 3 strixwolf_blood_debt Strixwolf Blood Debt checkbox
 bramble_outcome Bramble Outcome select unresolved killed captured spared negotiated
 escaped let_cargo bramble_truth_learned Bramble Truth Learned checkbox
 package_status Package Status select held lost hush_trust Hush Trust select low
 neutral high custodian_route Custodian Route select unknown safe dangerous
 ward_awareness Ward Awareness select none seed aware festival_boon Festival Boon
 select none charm favor market_find goodwill custodian_trust Custodian Trust select
 low neutral high keystone_understanding Keystone Understanding select surface deep
 hush_clues Hush...

- Mechanicids: adversary-attacks armor-slots damage-thresholds restrained vulnerable damage-rolls memory-delve untethered lifedrain fear countdown presence knowledge
- Playerquestions: Who calls someone back? What memory do you give it, or refuse to give it? Who stands over the body while the soul finds its way home?
- Relationshipprompts: Which PC quietly checks on someone else here? Who disagrees about the right thing to do without breaking trust?
- Ownershipprompt: Name one detail in Legacy Security Skeletons that belongs to your character's point of view.
- Fearsponds: Spend Fear to tick the ritual countdown, expose the Custodian, activate ward backlash, or trigger Market Correction. Tick the Ritual Countdown the wrong direction or expose the Custodian. Trigger Market Correction, Pass-Through, Memory Delve, or Group Attack when fiction supports it.
- Choicesconsequences: Take or answer a Memory Delve. A buried fear enters the scene at the player's chosen comfort level. On hit: 3d4+9 magic and Vulnerable until next rest. The denouement can name what the party protected emotionally.
 protected_whom=party/shared Cost: damage and vulnerability; reward: character payoff. player-visible Cover an Untethered ally. The ally is protected while unable to act. Presence/Knowledge 13 or countdown progress can restore action.
 protected_whom records the rescue. protected_whom=party Reward: emotional core of finale. player-visible Defeat or break a wraith. Wraith pressure drops. Tick ritual_countdown -1 on defeat or equivalent pressure removal. The ritual approaches completion and memory pressure recedes. ritual_countdown -1 Reward: progress.
 player-visible Ignore an isolated ally. The wraith tightens pressure. GM can spend Fear for Pass-Through or intensify Vulnerable pressure. S05-05 begins harsher and protected_whom may record a failure. protected_whom unresolved or custodian_fate risk Penalty: emotional and tactical cost. player-visible
- Lootclues: Use Skeleton remnants table
- Handoutids: Stamped breastplate
- Sourcescenelug: S05-04-legacy-security-skeletons
- Sourcefiles: dist/Act5_Upgrade_Packet/ACT5_SCENE_RESEARCH.md
 dist/Act5_Upgrade_Packet/ACT5_PER_CHARACTER.md
- References: Miremist edge #MAP-LOC-the-miremist Wraith combat map #MAP-COMBAT-S05-06
- Storyscope: Perceived antagonist: the forest. True antagonist: the corporate lie

about the forest. The players never confront it directly. They are meant to feel it by the end. Every act offers at least one guaranteed and one earned hint that the danger is manufactured and the forest is not the enemy. Soul-Audit Wraiths bear audit glyphs and say, "Unauthorized soul-resonance detected. Submit for audit."

REFLAVOR GUARANTEED A defeated wraith leaves a Soulspire compliance tag or coil-credit token instead of natural remains. ADD GUARANTEED Wraiths ignore forest creatures and home only on ritual soul-magic. ADD EARNED Instinct Medium 15 A player can read the markings and name Soulspire without the GM naming it first. ADD EARNED Knowledge Medium 15 Optional flag: Legacy Skeletons carry scraps of old corporate credentials. FLAG SEED Optional flag: Legacy Skeletons carry scraps of old corporate credentials. FLAG SEED Instinct: target logic. Knowledge: read markings. ACT5 Act 5: Open Vale defense 200 2:40 to 3:20 3:20 countdown 8, skeletons, wraiths, Market Correction Lower the countdown start to 6; cap wraith reinforcements.

- Livetools: encounter S05-04 MAP-S05-03 pages/combat/s05-03.html

- Percharacterlayer: marlowe-fairwind Marlowe Fairwind Memory Delve hook The Delve reaches for the oldest fear about duty and what the Keystone's custody costs.

Knowledge 14 May sense the wraiths are taking inventory of souls; deepest seed, not explanation. Can turn duty-fear into protection. Marlowe, the wraith reaches for your oldest fear about your duty. Want to give it voice? barnacle Barnacle Memory Delve hook The Delve reaches for Barnacle's water-fear and the buried memory behind it. Can answer with fear, joke, refusal, or a hand reaching for another PC.

Barnacle, it reaches for the water-fear you never talk about. Want to show the table where it started? garrick-reed Garrick Reed Memory Delve hook The Delve dredges up someone he could not protect in his security past. Can ground another PC by naming mercy as strength. Garrick, it dredges up someone you couldn't protect. Want to face it? khari-nix Khari Nix Memory Delve hook The Delve reaches for the first time she could not shield someone she loved. Can take a Delve meant for a vulnerable ally or hold the line around an Untethered body. Khari, it shows you the one you couldn't save. Or you could take this hit so someone else doesn't. Which?...

- Takeawayhelp: Player takeaway You cannot out-muscle these; protect each other, cover the Untethered, and endure. "Shield each other. If someone gets knocked loose, hold the line around them until the clock frees them. Nobody fights these alone." "Close distance, guard whoever got hit, or take the Memory Delve so a vulnerable ally does not have to." This scene should make protection emotional, not just spatial. memory-delve vulnerable untethered fear Story takeaway The wraiths attack who you are, not just what you can take. "These do not want your blood. They want your worst memory and your soul out of your body." "If players ask what they are, describe floating soul-reaching wraiths first. Soul-Audit Wraith is the GM name after the image lands." The audit meaning is GM-only; let behavior imply the deeper system. memory-delve vulnerable untethered fear Mechanic takeaway Memory Delve, Vulnerable, Pass-Through, Untethered, and grounding an ally make care a live combat mechanic. "Far-range, hard hits, physical resistance. Memory Delve makes you Vulnerable. Pass-Through can make you Untethered until the countdown ticks down." "Stats: Difficulty 13, HP 6, Stress 3, ATK +3, Lifedrain Far 2d6+8 magic...

- Playerbeats: s05-04-not-body Soul Not your body assets/scenes/S05-04-legacy-security-skeletons.png Legacy Security Skeletons scene art for The Ward Renewal. The wraiths reach past armor and blood toward fear, memory, and the soul's tether. The wraiths reach past armor and blood toward fear, memory, and the soul's tether. The

wraiths reach past armor and blood toward fear, memory, and the soul's tether. text-first s05-04-memory Memory Memory Delve assets/scenes/S05-04-legacy-security-skeletons.png Legacy Security Skeletons scene art for The Ward Renewal. If a wraith drags up a memory, you can answer with a sentence, a symbol, or a refusal. The table does not need a full confession. If a wraith drags up a memory, you can answer with a sentence, a symbol, or a refusal. The table does not need a full confession. If a wraith drags up a memory, you can answer with a sentence, a symbol, or a refusal. The table does not need a full confession. text-first s05-04-untethered Untethered Call them back assets/scenes/S05-04-legacy-security-skeletons.png Legacy Security Skeletons scene art for The Ward Renewal. If someone's soul is knocked loose, cover them and call them back until the countdown frees them...

- Gmbeats: s05-04-not-body Soul Not your body Say: "This part hurts differently. You can answer with courage, care, refusal, or rescue." The wraiths reach past armor and blood toward fear, memory, and the soul's tether. The finale's emotional stakes arrive. Soul pressure uses conditions and rescue mechanics. Players understand the pressure has changed. Player takeaway Players understand the pressure has changed. "This part hurts differently. You can answer with courage, care, refusal, or rescue." "The table-facing answer is: Players understand the pressure has changed." Use this beat to give the players one visible next action: protect the center, read the field, spend prep, name who they shield, or choose what truth leaves with them. vulnerable untethered Story takeaway The finale's emotional stakes arrive. "This part hurts differently. You can answer with courage, care, refusal, or rescue." "The story answer is: The finale's emotional stakes arrive." Tie the answer to a visible Act 5 consequence: the ward steadies, the Custodian suffers, Hush is protected, or the final report changes who owns the truth. vulnerable untethered Mechanic takeaway Soul pressure uses conditions and rescue...
- Beatautoplayeligible: True
- Beatautoplaydefault: False
- Beatautoplayintervalms: 8500
- Playersafeprojection: S05-04 scene The Soul-Audit Wraiths assets/scenes/S05-04-legacy-security-skeletons.png Legacy Security Skeletons scene art for The Ward Renewal. The wraiths make care and grounding as important as attacks. The Ward Renewal Survive the wraiths, protect each other, and keep the ritual on track. The drifting things reach you, and they do not swing for your body. One presses a cold hand to a face and reaches inside, dredging up something buried. The other simply passes through a body like a door, and for a horrible moment a soul stands outside itself, unable to move, unable to act, while the fight roars on without them. These are worse than the dead. These ask questions you do not want to answer. s05-04-not-body Soul Not your body assets/scenes/S05-04-legacy-security-skeletons.png Legacy Security Skeletons scene art for The Ward Renewal. The wraiths reach past armor and blood toward fear, memory, and the soul's tether. The wraiths reach past armor and blood toward fear, memory, and the soul's tether. The wraiths reach past armor and blood toward fear, memory, and the soul's tether. text-first s05-04-memory Memory Memory Delve assets/scenes/S05-04-legacy-security-skeletons.png Legacy...
- Companionmapids: MAP-S05-03 MAP-LOC-open-valetm-ritual-site
- Slidenumber: 70
- Totalslides: 110

- Spotlights: SPOT-M-UNTETHERED untethered untethered M19 S05-04 high mandatory first-use-of-condition Your Soul Has Drifted A recoverable condition, not a dead end. You are temporarily Untethered: still present in the scene, but unable to act until the effect resolves. The party can protect, reach, steady, or recover you through proximity and action. Keep the player involved by asking what memory or sensation they are fighting through. Untethered condition wiki/mechanic/untethered stalled-player-recovery Prevent the condition from feeling like the player has been removed from the story. mechanic defer-if-clock-critical True True SPOT-C-VARIAN-LATE varian-soto Varian Soto late S05-04 high optional first-use-of-condition Varian, What Changed? Memory plus perception closes his arc. Varian, what does your learned sense say now? Give the party what this place really is, without naming what you cannot prove. Spotlight: Varian wiki/character/varian in-scene-prompts character defer-if-clock-critical True True

- Spotlightsummary: 1 1

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